

Employee Handbook

Version 2.0 | Effective: April 1, 2025 | HR Department

1. Introduction

Welcome to Meridian Technologies. This handbook outlines the policies, procedures, and expectations for all employees. It is intended as a reference guide and does not constitute a contract of employment. Employees are encouraged to review this document thoroughly and direct any questions to the People & Culture team.

2. Working Hours

Standard working hours are Monday through Friday, 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM local time. Employees are entitled to a one-hour unpaid lunch break each day. Remote work is now permitted up to three days per week without requiring prior manager approval, in line with our updated hybrid work policy.

3. Leave Policy

3.1 Annual Leave

All full-time employees are entitled to 18 days of paid annual leave per year, increased from 15 days. Leave accrues at a rate of 1.5 days per month. Unused leave may be carried over up to a maximum of 8 days.

3.2 Sick Leave

Employees are entitled to 12 days of paid sick leave per calendar year. A medical certificate is required for absences exceeding 3 consecutive days.

3.3 Mental Health Leave

Effective April 2025, employees are entitled to 2 additional paid mental health days per year. These may be taken without requiring any documentation or justification.

4. Code of Conduct

All employees are expected to behave with integrity and professionalism. Discrimination, harassment, or bullying of any kind will not be tolerated. Violations will be subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination. Employees are encouraged to report concerns anonymously via the Ethics Hotline.

5. Performance Reviews

Review Type	Frequency	Conducted By
Probation Review	End of 3-month probation	Line Manager
Quarterly Check-in	Every 3 months	Line Manager
Mid-Year Review	June	Line Manager + HR
Annual Appraisal	December	Line Manager + HR

6. Benefits

Meridian Technologies offers the following benefits to eligible employees:

- Health insurance (employee and dependents)
- Provident fund contribution at 12% of basic salary
- Annual performance bonus (up to 15% of annual salary)
- Gym membership reimbursement up to ■5,000 per month
- Learning & development budget of ■25,000 per year

7. IT and Equipment Policy

All employees will be provided with a laptop and required peripherals on their first day. Equipment must be returned in good condition upon separation. Personal use of company equipment should be minimal and must not compromise security. Employees may request a monitor and ergonomic chair for their home office setup.

8. Grievance Procedure

Employees with a grievance should first raise the matter with their line manager. If unresolved, the issue should be escalated to HR in writing. All grievances will be acknowledged within 3 business days, reduced from 5 days.